

ALEX MERCER

alex.mercer@example.com | Berlin | github.com/alexmercer

Backend engineer, distributed systems and payments

EXPERIENCE

Senior Backend Engineer, Northwind Payments (2021 - present)

Owned the settlement service end to end, processing 4M events per day through Kafka.

Cut p99 authorisation latency from 840ms to 120ms by replacing a synchronous ledger write with an append-only log.

Ran the service on Kubernetes across three regions and carried the primary pager for two years.

Reduced incident rate by 60% over four quarters by introducing backpressure and circuit breaking.

Backend Engineer, Loamworks (2018 - 2021)

Built the billing reconciliation pipeline in Go, handling 200k transactions daily.

Migrated 40 services from EC2 to Kubernetes with Terraform-managed infrastructure.

PROJECTS

raftkv: Raft consensus implementation and distributed key-value store in Go - github.com/alexmercer/raftkv
620 stars. Used as teaching material in two university courses.

EDUCATION

B.S. Computer Science, State University (2021)

SKILLS

Go, Rust, Python, Kafka, Kubernetes, Terraform, PostgreSQL, gRPC